

The Mad Titan Thanos embarks on a brutal, universe-spanning crusade to collect all six Infinity Stones to erase half of all living things and fix what he views as galactic overpopulation. The story moves at a breakneck pace across several cosmic and earthly fronts, tracking Thanos's relentless march toward his ultimate goal.

The Opening Assault The story begins in deep space. Thanos and his adoptive children, the Black Order, intercept a ship carrying the surviving citizens of Asgard. Thanos easily overpowers Thor and kills Loki to claim the Space Stone (housed in the Tesseract). He already possesses the Power Stone, which he seized after decimating the planet Xandar. Before he is incapacitated, Heimdall uses the last of his dark magic to send Hulk crashing down to Earth to warn humanity. Hulk lands in the Sanctum Sanctorum in New York City, reverting back to Bruce Banner and warning Doctor Strange and Tony Stark (Iron Man) that Thanos is coming.

The Earth and Outer Space Fronts The narrative quickly splits into three parallel threads as Thanos's forces hunt down the remaining stones:

The New York and Space Trio: The Black Order attacks New York to steal the Time Stone from Doctor Strange. Iron Man, Doctor Strange, and a young Peter Parker (Spider-Man) end up aboard a moving alien spaceship heading into deep space. They manage to kill the alien commander, rescue Strange, and decide to take the fight directly to Thanos's ruined home planet, Titan.

The Guardians of the Galaxy: The Guardians answer the Asgardian distress signal and rescue a drifting Thor. Splitting up, Thor travels with Rocket and Groot to the cosmic forge of Nidavellir to create a god-killing weapon: the axe Stormbreaker. Meanwhile, Star-Lord, Gamora, Drax, and Mantis head to Knowhere to secure the Reality Stone, only to find Thanos has already claimed it. Thanos kidnaps Gamora, his adoptive daughter, because she is the only one who knows the location of the hidden Soul Stone.

The Earth Defenders: In Scotland, other members of the Black Order ambush Wanda Maximoff (Scarlet Witch) and Vision to rip the Mind Stone directly out of Vision's forehead. Captain America, Black Widow, and Falcon intervene, rescuing them. Knowing Vision cannot survive if the stone is forcefully taken, they travel to the advanced African nation of Wakanda, hoping King T'Challa and his sister Shuri can safely remove the stone without killing him.

The Ultimate Sacrifices On the desolate planet of Vormir, Thanos forces Gamora to guide him to the Soul Stone. The stone's keeper reveals that it requires a terrible price: the sacrifice of someone the seeker truly loves. Tearfully, Thanos throws Gamora over the cliff, claiming the stone.

Back on Titan, Iron Man, Spider-Man, and Doctor Strange team up with the remaining Guardians of the Galaxy. They construct an ambush and nearly strip the Infinity Gauntlet off Thanos's hand. However, when Star-Lord learns that Thanos murdered Gamora, he loses control and attacks him, breaking the team's hold. Thanos brutally beats Iron Man. To save Stark's life, Doctor Strange willingly hands over the Time Stone, despite previously swearing to protect it at all costs. Strange cryptically notes that this is the only way out of 14 million possible futures.

The Battle of Wakanda and The Snap Thanos arrives on Earth,

entering Wakanda where a massive war is raging between Avengers, Wakandan forces, and thousands of alien Outriders. Even with Thor arriving mid-battle with his newly forged Stormbreaker to turn the tide, the heroes cannot stop Thanos. In a desperate final move, Vision begs Wanda to destroy the Mind Stone embedded in his head. She uses her powers to shatter the stone, killing Vision just as Thanos reaches them. Unfazed, Thanos uses his newly acquired Time Stone to rewind time, bringing Vision back to life, and brutally rips the Mind Stone from his forehead himself, completing the Infinity Gauntlet. Thor lunges from the sky, striking Thanos square in the chest with Stormbreaker. Barely clinging to life, Thanos looks at Thor and smiles, uttering the iconic line: "You should have gone for the head." Thanos snaps his fingers. The Aftermath The movie ends in absolute silence as half of all life across the universe turns to ash. On Titan, Star-Lord, Drax, Mantis, Doctor Strange, and Spider-Man fade away, leaving a devastated Tony Stark and Nebula alone. In Wakanda, Bucky Barnes, Black Panther, Groot, Scarlet Witch, and Falcon dissolve into dust. The surviving heroes—Captain America, Thor, Black Widow, Banner, and War Machine—are left sitting in the dirt, completely defeated. Across the galaxy, Thanos sits quietly on a peaceful porch, watching the sun rise over a newly quiet universe.